

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 17: India, a Home to Many

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	17 — India, a Home to Many
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the classic traps: not all communities came to TRADE - many came as refugees fleeing persecution, and the Siddis were brought ENSLAVED; Islam first came PEACEFULLY through Arab merchants from the 7th century (India's oldest mosque), separately from the later invasions; newcomers KEPT their identities (synagogues, fire temples, churches) while joining Indian society; a refugee (fleeing danger) differs from an immigrant (seeking opportunity); and diversity ENRICHED Indian culture, in the spirit of vasudhaiva kutumbakam. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. The central value of this chapter, 'vasudhaiva kutumbakam', means:

- (A) 'the whole world is one family' (B) 'a guest is like God'
(C) 'the world is one market' (D) 'India for Indians only'

2. 'Atithi devo bhava' expresses India's tradition of:

- (A) hospitality - treating a guest like God (B) keeping out all foreigners
(C) trading only with neighbours (D) worshipping many gods

3. The chapter says India has, for thousands of years, been:

- (A) a home to many communities from around the world
(B) closed to all outsiders (C) home to only one community
(D) ruled by foreign refugees

4. Newcomers to India generally:

- (A) were forced to abandon all their traditions (B) never mixed with Indian society at all
(C) ruled over the Indians
(D) kept their own traditions while becoming part of Indian society

5. The idea of vasudhaiva kutumbakam treats India's diversity as:

- (A) a weakness to be removed
- (B) a strength and a civilisational ideal of acceptance
- (C) a threat to be feared
- (D) unimportant

6. The chapter says newcomers came to India for two main reasons:

- (A) only ever for trade
- (B) seeking refuge from persecution, or seeking opportunity through trade
- (C) only ever to conquer
- (D) only to study

7. The claim 'all the communities came to India to trade and prosper' is wrong because:

- (A) everyone came freely to trade
- (B) no one ever came for trade
- (C) all came to conquer
- (D) many came fleeing persecution, and the Siddis were brought enslaved

8. A 'refugee' differs from an ordinary immigrant in that a refugee:

- (A) always comes freely seeking trade
- (B) is never a newcomer
- (C) flees danger or persecution and has little choice
- (D) can never keep any traditions

9. The chapter calls the two paths by which people came:

- (A) 'conquest' and 'trade'
- (B) 'war' and 'peace'
- (C) 'refuge' and 'opportunity'
- (D) 'land' and 'sea'

10. Arab merchants coming to trade and Parsis fleeing persecution show, respectively:

- (A) refuge and opportunity
- (B) conquest and refuge
- (C) opportunity and conquest
- (D) opportunity and refuge

11. The Jewish communities of India include the:

- (A) Mappila and the Siddis
- (B) Parsis and the Armenians
- (C) Baha'is and the Tibetans
- (D) Bene Israel and the Cochin Jews

12. A 'synagogue' is:

- (A) a Zoroastrian fire temple
- (B) a Muslim mosque
- (C) a Jewish house of worship and assembly
- (D) a Christian church

13. That Indian Jews built synagogues and kept their faith shows that India allowed:

- (A) complete loss of all traditions
- (B) identity-preserving integration
- (C) total separation from society
- (D) rule by the newcomers

14. The Jews are an example of a community that came to India seeking:

- (A) refuge from persecution, keeping their traditions here
- (B) to conquer Indian kingdoms
- (C) to rule over India
- (D) only to study Sanskrit

15. The Syriac Christians are an ancient Christian community of:

- (A) Gujarat
- (B) Tibet
- (C) Kerala
- (D) Armenia

16. The Syriac Christians of Kerala are notable as:

- (A) a community founded only in the 20th century
- (B) one of the oldest Christian communities, who kept their traditions in India
- (C) African-origin people brought enslaved
- (D) Zoroastrian fire-worshippers

17. Like the Jews and Parsis, the Syriac Christians are an example of a community that:

- (A) preserved its faith while becoming part of Indian society
- (B) lost its religion entirely
- (C) refused to settle in India
- (D) conquered Kerala

18. The Parsis of India are followers of:

- (A) Judaism
- (B) the Baha'i faith
- (C) Zoroastrianism
- (D) Tibetan Buddhism

19. The Parsis settled mainly in:

- (A) Kerala
- (B) Gujarat
- (C) Tibet
- (D) Armenia

20. Zoroastrianism was founded by:

- (A) Zarathushtra
- (B) the prophet's chief enemy
- (C) Ahura Mazda himself
- (D) a Mappila merchant

21. Zoroastrianism is based on the worship of one God, called:

- (A) many gods of nature
- (B) no god at all
- (C) the Buddha
- (D) Ahura Mazda, and choosing good over evil

22. Zoroastrianism is described as:

- (A) one of the world's oldest religions
- (B) the newest religion in the world
- (C) a branch of Judaism
- (D) a modern Indian invention

23. The Parsis came to India mainly:

- (A) to conquer Gujarat
- (B) only to trade spices
- (C) to rule over India
- (D) seeking refuge from persecution, and kept their fire temples and faith

24. The claim 'Islam came to India only through invasions' is wrong because:

- (A) Islam never reached India
- (B) Islam came only in the 20th century
- (C) Islam first came peacefully through Arab merchants on the west coast from the 7th century
- (D) Islam came only by sea conquest

25. Arab merchants on India's west coast built:

- (A) the first synagogue
- (B) a Zoroastrian fire temple
- (C) a Tibetan monastery
- (D) India's oldest mosque

26. Arab merchants are an example of newcomers who came seeking:

- (A) refuge from persecution
- (B) opportunity through trade
- (C) to conquer India
- (D) enslavement

27. The 'Mappila' community of Kerala formed when:

- (A) Tibetan refugees arrived in the 1950s
- (B) African people were brought enslaved
- (C) Arab merchants settled and married locally
- (D) Polish children were given shelter

28. That Islam arrived peacefully through Arab traders, separately from the later invasions, shows that:

- (A) religions spread only through war
- (B) Islam never spread peacefully anywhere
- (C) trade and religion never mix
- (D) a religion can spread by trade and settlement, not only by conquest

29. The peaceful arrival of Islam via Arab merchants happened:

- (A) only after the Ghurid invasions
- (B) in the 20th century
- (C) never at all
- (D) from the 7th century, long before the later military invasions

30. The Siddis are a community of:

- (A) Tibetan origin
- (B) Armenian origin
- (C) African origin
- (D) Polish origin

31. The Siddis came to India:

- (A) freely as wealthy traders
- (B) brought enslaved between the 7th and 19th centuries
- (C) as conquering soldiers
- (D) as Polish refugee children

32. Today the Siddis are recognised as a:

- (A) foreign embassy
- (B) trading guild
- (C) scheduled tribe
- (D) royal dynasty

33. A 'scheduled tribe' is a community:

- (A) officially recognised by the Indian Constitution for special support and protection
- (B) banned from living in India
- (C) made up only of foreigners
- (D) that rules a state

34. The Armenians are remembered as a community that came to India mainly for:

- (A) conquering Indian kingdoms
- (B) trade and opportunity, settling and building churches
- (C) ruling over India
- (D) enslaving local people

- 35.** Like the Jews, Parsis and Armenians, the communities in this chapter generally:
- (A) erased Indian culture
 - (B) were expelled at once
 - (C) kept their own faith and customs while contributing to Indian life
 - (D) refused to settle
- 36.** The Baha'is are included as a community that came to India:
- (A) to conquer the country
 - (B) also seeking refuge and acceptance, adding to India's diversity
 - (C) as the original inhabitants of India
 - (D) to rule over other faiths
- 37.** The Baha'i community in India illustrates that India's acceptance of newcomers:
- (A) stopped completely after ancient times
 - (B) applied only to traders
 - (C) continued into modern times
 - (D) was offered only to one religion
- 38.** The 'Good Maharaja' is remembered for:
- (A) giving shelter to Polish children during a time of war
 - (B) leading an invasion of India
 - (C) founding Zoroastrianism
 - (D) building India's oldest mosque
- 39.** The Polish children sheltered by the 'Good Maharaja' were:
- (A) wealthy traders seeking profit
 - (B) conquering soldiers
 - (C) refugees fleeing the dangers of war
 - (D) original inhabitants of India
- 40.** The story of the 'Good Maharaja' and the Polish children is an example of India's:
- (A) refusal to help any foreigners
 - (B) conquest of distant lands
 - (C) tradition of giving refuge to those fleeing danger
 - (D) rejection of all refugees
- 41.** The Tibetan refugees came to India:
- (A) fleeing danger, and were given shelter
 - (B) as wealthy traders only
 - (C) as conquering armies
 - (D) as the original people of India
- 42.** 'Sowa Rigpa', associated with the Tibetan community, is:
- (A) the Tibetan system of medicine ('Art of Healing'), now part of India's AYUSH programme
 - (B) a Jewish house of worship
 - (C) a Zoroastrian prayer
 - (D) an Arab trade route
- 43.** That Tibetan medicine (Sowa Rigpa) became part of India's AYUSH programme shows that newcomers:
- (A) enriched India by adding to its knowledge and culture
 - (B) took away from Indian culture
 - (C) kept everything strictly to themselves
 - (D) were forced to abandon their knowledge
- 44.** The Tibetan refugees are a modern example of India offering:

- (A) opportunity to wealthy traders (B) refuge to people fleeing danger
- (C) conquest of a neighbour (D) rejection of outsiders

45. 'Persecution' means:

- (A) a warm welcome to newcomers (B) a kind of trade agreement
- (C) hostility and ill-treatment, often for religious, ethnic, social or political reasons
- (D) a system of medicine

46. 'Refuge' (or asylum) is:

- (A) a profit made from trade (B) a place of worship
- (C) a tax on newcomers
- (D) shelter or protection given to someone fleeing danger or persecution

47. A 'cosmopolitan' place is one that is:

- (A) at home with people of many cultures - 'a citizen of the world'
- (B) closed to all outsiders (C) home to only one culture
- (D) ruled by a single religion

48. 'Pluralism' is:

- (A) the rule of one community over all others
- (B) the removal of all minorities
- (C) a kind of trade route
- (D) the peaceful coexistence of many different communities, faiths and cultures in one society

49. The 'ethos' of a people means their:

- (A) characteristic spirit or guiding values
- (B) system of medicine
- (C) place of worship (D) trade goods

50. To 'immigrate' is to enter a country, while to 'emigrate' is to:

- (A) enter the same country twice (B) leave a country
- (C) rule a country (D) trade with a country

51. 'Tolerance', a value shown by India in this chapter, means:

- (A) forcing everyone to share one belief
- (B) rejecting all newcomers
- (C) ignoring other people entirely
- (D) accepting and respecting beliefs and customs different from one's own

52. The claim 'refugee communities lost their own identity in India' is wrong because they:

- (A) abandoned every tradition at once
- (B) were never allowed to settle
- (C) ruled over the Indians
- (D) kept their synagogues, fire temples, churches and languages while joining Indian society

53. India's pattern of welcoming newcomers is best described as allowing them to:

- (A) keep apart and never integrate at all
- (B) give up their identities completely
- (C) take over the country
- (D) integrate into society while keeping their own identities

54. The claim 'welcoming so many communities must have weakened India's culture' is wrong because newcomers:

- (A) removed parts of Indian culture
- (B) added foods, words, crafts, music and faiths, making Indian culture richer
- (C) kept everything to themselves
- (D) replaced Indian culture entirely

55. The chapter treats India's diversity of communities as:

- (A) a weakness and a danger
- (B) a source of strength and richness
- (C) something to be erased
- (D) unimportant to India

56. Foods, words, crafts and music brought by different communities show that diversity:

- (A) enriches a culture rather than weakening it
- (B) always destroys a culture
- (C) never affects a culture
- (D) makes all cultures identical

57. India keeping many faiths and communities together peacefully is an example of:

- (A) persecution
- (B) pluralism
- (C) conquest
- (D) enslavement

58. Which pairing of community and reason for coming is correct?

- (A) Parsis - trade; Arab merchants - refuge
- (B) Siddis - free wealthy traders
- (C) Tibetans - conquering armies
- (D) Parsis - refuge from persecution; Arab merchants - opportunity through trade

59. The chapter says vasudhaiva kutumbakam has:

- (A) relevance only to ancient times
- (B) no meaning in the modern world
- (C) universal relevance for today's world
- (D) meaning only for traders

60. A student says, 'Everyone came to India to trade, refugees lost their identity, and all this diversity weakened Indian culture.' The best correction is:

- (A) all three statements are correct
- (B) many came as refugees, communities kept their identities, and diversity enriched Indian culture
- (C) everyone came to trade but kept their identity
- (D) diversity weakened the culture though refugees stayed

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 17: India, a Home to Many

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	D	21	D	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	C	22	A	32	C	42	A	52	D
3	A	13	B	23	D	33	A	43	A	53	D
4	D	14	A	24	C	34	B	44	B	54	B
5	B	15	C	25	D	35	C	45	C	55	B
6	B	16	B	26	B	36	B	46	D	56	A
7	D	17	A	27	C	37	C	47	A	57	B
8	C	18	C	28	D	38	A	48	D	58	D
9	C	19	B	29	D	39	C	49	A	59	C
10	D	20	A	30	C	40	C	50	B	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- 1. (A)** Vasudhaiva kutumbakam means 'the whole world is one family', the chapter's core value. 'A guest is like God' is atithi devo bhava; the others are not the phrase's meaning.
- 2. (A)** Atithi devo bhava ('a guest is like God') expresses hospitality. It is not about excluding foreigners, trade, or polytheism.
- 3. (A)** India has long been home to many communities from around the world. It was not closed, single-community, or refugee-ruled.
- 4. (D)** Communities kept their traditions while integrating into Indian society - identity-preserving integration. They were not forced to abandon traditions, kept apart, or made rulers.
- 5. (B)** Vasudhaiva kutumbakam frames diversity as a strength and an ideal of acceptance. It is not a weakness, threat, or trivial matter.
- 6. (B)** Newcomers came either for refuge (fleeing persecution) or opportunity (trade). It was not trade-only, conquest-only, or study-only.

- 7. (D)** Many (Jews, Syriac Christians, Parsis, Baha'is) fled persecution, and the Siddis were brought enslaved - not all came freely to trade.
- 8. (C)** A refugee flees danger with little choice, unlike those who come freely seeking opportunity. Both are newcomers, and refugees can keep traditions.
- 9. (C)** The two paths are 'refuge' (fleeing persecution) and 'opportunity' (seeking trade). They are not conquest/trade, war/peace, or land/sea.
- 10. (D)** Arab merchants came for opportunity (trade); Parsis came for refuge (fleeing persecution). The order is opportunity then refuge, not the reverse, and neither came to conquer.
- 11. (D)** India's Jewish communities include the Bene Israel and Cochin Jews. The Mappila are Kerala Muslims, the Siddis African-origin, and the others are different communities.
- 12. (C)** A synagogue (Greek synagoge, 'a gathering together') is a Jewish place of worship. A fire temple is Zoroastrian, a mosque Muslim, and a church Christian.
- 13. (B)** Keeping synagogues and faith while joining Indian society shows identity-preserving integration. It was not loss of traditions, separation, or newcomer-rule.
- 14. (A)** The Jews sought refuge from persecution and kept their traditions in India. They did not come to conquer, rule, or only study.
- 15. (C)** The Syriac Christians are an ancient community of Kerala. Gujarat is linked to the Parsis, Tibet to Tibetan refugees, and Armenia to the Armenians.
- 16. (B)** The Syriac Christians are among the oldest Christian communities and kept their traditions in India. They are not modern, the enslaved Siddis, or Zoroastrians.
- 17. (A)** The Syriac Christians preserved their faith while joining Indian society. They did not lose their religion, refuse to settle, or conquer Kerala.
- 18. (C)** The Parsis follow Zoroastrianism. Judaism is the Jews', the Baha'i faith the Baha'is', and Tibetan Buddhism the Tibetans'.
- 19. (B)** The Parsis settled mainly in Gujarat. Kerala is linked to the Syriac Christians, Tibet to Tibetan refugees, and Armenia to the Armenians.
- 20. (A)** Zoroastrianism was founded by the prophet Zarathushtra. Ahura Mazda is its one God (not its human founder), and a Mappila merchant is unrelated.
- 21. (D)** Zoroastrianism worships one God, Ahura Mazda, and stresses choosing good over evil. It is not polytheist, godless, or Buddhist.

- 22. (A)** Zoroastrianism is one of the world's oldest religions. It is not the newest, a branch of Judaism, or a modern Indian invention.
- 23. (D)** The Parsis fled persecution and preserved their fire temples and faith in India. They did not come to conquer, only to trade, or to rule.
- 24. (C)** Islam first came peacefully via Arab merchants on the west coast from the 7th century, long before the later invasions. It did reach India, not only recently, and not only by conquest.
- 25. (D)** Arab merchants built India's oldest mosque on the west coast. A synagogue is Jewish, a fire temple Zoroastrian, and a monastery Tibetan Buddhist.
- 26. (B)** Arab merchants came seeking opportunity through trade, not refuge, conquest, or as enslaved people.
- 27. (C)** The Mappila are the Kerala Muslim community formed as Arab merchants settled and married locally. The other options describe Tibetans, Siddis and the Polish children.
- 28. (D)** Islam's peaceful arrival via traders shows religion spreading by trade and settlement, not only conquest. Religions do spread peacefully, and trade and religion did mix here.
- 29. (D)** Islam came peacefully via Arab merchants from the 7th century, well before the later invasions. It was not after the Ghurids, in the 20th century, or never.
- 30. (C)** The Siddis are of African origin. Tibetan, Armenian and Polish communities are separate groups in the chapter.
- 31. (B)** The Siddis were brought enslaved between the 7th and 19th centuries. They did not come as free traders, conquerors, or Polish children.
- 32. (C)** The Siddis are now a scheduled tribe, officially recognised for special support. They are not an embassy, guild, or dynasty.
- 33. (A)** A scheduled tribe is constitutionally recognised for special support and protection. It is not banned, foreigner-only, or a ruling group.
- 34. (B)** The Armenians came largely for trade, settling and building churches. They did not conquer, rule, or enslave.
- 35. (C)** These communities kept their faith and customs while contributing to Indian life. They did not erase Indian culture, get expelled, or refuse to settle.
- 36. (B)** The Baha'is came seeking refuge and acceptance, adding to India's diversity. They were not conquerors, original inhabitants, or rulers over others.

- 37. (C)** The Baha'is show India's acceptance continuing into modern times. It did not stop after antiquity, apply only to traders, or favour one religion.
- 38. (A)** The 'Good Maharaja' sheltered Polish children fleeing war. He did not lead an invasion, found Zoroastrianism, or build the oldest mosque.
- 39. (C)** The Polish children were refugees fleeing war's dangers. They were not traders, soldiers, or original inhabitants.
- 40. (C)** Sheltering the Polish children shows India's tradition of giving refuge. It is the opposite of refusing help, conquest, or rejecting refugees.
- 41. (A)** Tibetan refugees fled danger and were given shelter in India. They were not mere traders, conquerors, or original inhabitants.
- 42. (A)** Sowa Rigpa is the Tibetan 'Art of Healing', now part of India's AYUSH programme. It is not a synagogue, a Zoroastrian prayer, or a trade route.
- 43. (A)** Sowa Rigpa joining AYUSH shows newcomers enriching India's knowledge and culture. They did not subtract from it, hoard it, or abandon it.
- 44. (B)** The Tibetan refugees show India offering refuge to those fleeing danger. It was not trader-opportunity, conquest, or rejection.
- 45. (C)** Persecution is hostility and ill-treatment, often on religious or other grounds - what many refugees fled. It is not a welcome, a trade deal, or medicine.
- 46. (D)** Refuge or asylum is shelter for those fleeing danger. It is not trade profit, a place of worship, or a tax.
- 47. (A)** Cosmopolitan (Greek kosmos 'world' + polites 'citizen') means at home with many cultures. It is not closed, single-culture, or single-religion.
- 48. (D)** Pluralism (Latin plus/pluris, 'more') is the peaceful coexistence of many communities and faiths. It is not one-community rule, removing minorities, or a trade route.
- 49. (A)** Ethos (Greek ethos, 'character') is a people's guiding spirit or values - here, acceptance. It is not medicine, a temple, or trade goods.
- 50. (B)** To emigrate is to leave a country; to immigrate is to enter one (both from Latin migrare). It is not double-entry, ruling, or trading.
- 51. (D)** Tolerance (Latin tolerare, 'to bear') is accepting and respecting different beliefs and customs. It is not forced uniformity, rejection, or indifference.

52. (D) Communities kept synagogues, fire temples, churches and languages while integrating - identity-preserving integration. They did not abandon traditions, fail to settle, or rule.

53. (D) India allowed newcomers to integrate while keeping their identities. It was neither total separation, total assimilation, nor takeover.

54. (B) Newcomers added foods, words, crafts, music and faiths, enriching Indian culture. They did not subtract from it, hoard it, or replace it.

55. (B) The chapter treats diversity as a source of strength and richness, in the spirit of vasudhaiva kutumbakam. It is not a weakness, to be erased, or unimportant.

56. (A) Borrowed foods, words, crafts and music show diversity enriching culture. It does not destroy it, leave it unaffected, or make all cultures identical.

57. (B) Many communities coexisting peacefully is pluralism. It is the opposite of persecution, conquest, or enslavement.

58. (D) The Parsis came for refuge from persecution; Arab merchants for trade opportunity. The reversal, the 'Siddis as free traders' (they were enslaved) and 'Tibetans as conquerors' (they were refugees) are wrong.

59. (C) Vasudhaiva kutumbakam ('the world is one family') is presented as having universal relevance for today's world. It is not ancient-only, meaningless now, or trader-only.

60. (B) Many came fleeing persecution (not all to trade), communities kept their identities, and diversity enriched Indian culture - correcting all three errors. The other options keep one or more misconceptions.